

INTELASSIST THREAT RESEARCH: APT29 COZY BEAR ADVISORY

Executive Summary:

IntelAssist Threat Research has detected a spear-phishing campaign attributed to threat actor APT29. The adversary distributes malicious archives exploiting CVE-2023-38831 for remote code execution. Observed C2 infrastructure includes IP 185.220.101.5 and domain login-microsoft-secure.com.

Technical Analysis & Attack Chain:

1. Spear-phishing email delivers weaponized ZIP file (SHA256: e3b0c44298fc1c149afb4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca4959).
2. WinRAR vulnerability CVE-2023-38831 executes hidden script without user interaction.
3. Outbound beacon connects to 185.220.101.5 on port 443 to fetch beacon.dll.
4. Adversary deploys mimikatz.exe for memory credential harvesting.

Recommended Containment Actions:

1. Immediately block IP 185.220.101.5 and 194.26.29.112 across all perimeter firewalls.
2. Sinkhole phishing domain login-microsoft-secure.com and payload server cdn-update-service.org.
3. Patch all endpoints against CVE-2023-38831 and enforce MFA on administrative accounts.